

This function takes in simple textual information and puts it into a more meaningful data structure that lets you work with the information beyond just printing it. The strings 'jimi' and 'hendrix' are now labeled as a first name and last name. You can easily extend this function to accept optional values like a middle name, an age, an occupation, or any other information you want to store about a person. For example, the following change allows you to store a person's age as well:

---

```
def build_person(first_name, last_name, age=None):
    """Return a dictionary of information about a person."""
    person = {'first': first_name, 'last': last_name}
    if age:
        person['age'] = age
    return person

musician = build_person('jimi', 'hendrix', age=27)
print(musician)
```

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We add a new optional parameter `age` to the function definition and assign the parameter the special value `None`, which is used when a variable has no specific value assigned to it. You can think of `None` as a placeholder value. In conditional tests, `None` evaluates to `False`. If the function call includes a value for `age`, that value is stored in the dictionary. This function always stores a person's name, but it can also be modified to store any other information you want about a person.

## Using a Function with a while Loop

You can use functions with all the Python structures you've learned about so far. For example, let's use the `get_formatted_name()` function with a while loop to greet users more formally. Here's a first attempt at greeting people using their first and last names:

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```
greeter.py def get_formatted_name(first_name, last_name):
    """Return a full name, neatly formatted."""
    full_name = f"{first_name} {last_name}"
    return full_name.title()

# This is an infinite loop!
while True:
    ❶ print("\nPlease tell me your name:")
    f_name = input("First name: ")
    l_name = input("Last name: ")

    formatted_name = get_formatted_name(f_name, l_name)
    print(f"\nHello, {formatted_name}!")
```

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For this example, we use a simple version of `get_formatted_name()` that doesn't involve middle names. The while loop asks the user to enter their name, and we prompt for their first and last name separately ❶.

But there's one problem with this while loop: We haven't defined a quit condition. Where do you put a quit condition when you ask for a series of